

Christ Full Deity

doc-christ-full-deity

Christology · Person · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Jesus Christ is fully and uniquely God, eternally begotten and not created, equal in essence with the Father.

In plain language

Six anchor texts apply the Greek word for God, theos, and identity formulae to Jesus in ways the grammar marks as real claims of deity, not polite titles. In John 1:1 the queried word order is decisive: the word theos stands before the verb was, and the subject the Word comes after it, which in this language signals a quality (the Word fully shares the divine nature), not an indefinite a god. John 8:58 sets a verb of coming to be, used for Abraham, against a bare present I am, used for Jesus with nothing completing it, echoing the divine self naming behind Exodus 3:14. John 20:28 has Thomas say to him, my Lord and my God, with the narrator marking it as address and Jesus not refusing it. Colossians 2:9 uses a word that appears only once in the whole New Testament, theotes, deity itself, and says the entire fullness of it lives in Christ bodily and permanently. Hebrews 1:8 has the Father address the Son as God on an everlasting throne. Philippians 2:6 says Christ was in the form of God and counted being equal with God not a thing to grasp, using the same equality word his opponents use against him in John 5:18. Why do some readers still divide? Their strongest moves are real grammar: theos in John 1:1 lacks the article, John 20:28 could in theory be an outburst, and words like firstborn and only begotten can suggest origin. Each move is answered from the words themselves: the article pattern is the quality construction, the narrator says Thomas spoke to him, firstborn is paired with creating all things, and only begotten is used of Isaac who was not an only child by birth. One link is genuinely thin: theotes and its near twin theiotes each appear only once, so their difference rests on word formation rather than on repeated usage. But the other anchors carry the weight on their own, and the pattern spans many authors and both Testaments, which is why it lands as a confident yes.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0011	Ἀβραάμ	Abraam	Abraham	
G0281	ἀμήν	amēn	amen	
G0725	ἄρπαγμός	harpagmos	something to grasp	1
G1096	γίνομαι	ginomai	to be	697
G1473	ἐγώ	egō	I/we	
G1510	εἰμί	eimi	to be	2,457
G2118	εὐθύτης	euthytes	righteousness	1
G2305	θειότης	theiotes	divinity	1
G2316	θεός	theos	God	1,311
G2320	θεότης	theotes	deity	1

G2362	θρόνος	thronos	throne	64
G2381	Θωμᾶς	Thōmas	Thomas	
G2470	ἴσος	isos	equal	8
G2730	κατοικέω	katoikeo	to dwell	45
G3056	λόγος	logos	word	339
G3439	μονογενής	monogenes	unique	9
G3444	μορφή	morphe	form	3
G3588	ὁ	ho	the/this/who	
G3956	πᾶς	pas	all	
G4138	πλήρωμα	pleroma	fulfillment	17
G4250	πρίν	prin	before	
G4314	πρός	pros	to/with	
G4416	πρωτότοκος	prototokos	firstborn	8
G4464	ῥάβδος	rhabdos	rod	12
G4985	σωματικῶς	somatikos	bodily	1
G5207	υἱός	huios	son	386
G5225	ὑπάρχω	hyparcho	be already	60

Plain meanings: STEP Bible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

Across distinct authors (Johannine, Pauline, Hebrews) the lexeme theos (G2316, 1311 NT occurrences in the queried Greek text) and identity formulae attach to Jesus in ways the queried morphology marks as non-attributive. John 1:1c orders the tokens anarthrous theos (N-NSM) before the copula en with articular ho logos (N-NSM) after, the qualitative predicate-nominative construction, not the indefinite a god. John 8:58 sets the aorist infinitive genesthai (Abraham coming to be) against the bare present eimi (no predicate complement). John 20:28 addresses Jesus (eipen auto, dative) as ho kyrios kai ho theos, articular. Col 2:9 predicates the durative katoikei of pan to pleroma tes theotetos (G2320, a NT hapax) somatikos. Heb 1:8 has the Father address the Son as ho theos with an eternal throne. Phil 2:6 says morphe theou and to einai isa theo (G2470, the same word the opponents use in John 5:18). The minority readings each rest on one grammatical move that the wider queried canon independently blunts. OT roots (Exod 3:14 ehyeh, Ps 45:6 elohim) supply pan-canonical grounding.

Scripture

John.1.1 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3056 λόγος, G2316 θεός, G1510 εἰμί, G4314 πρὸς

Force. Queried token order: clause two reads kai ho logos en pros ton theon, where ton theon is articular accusative (T-ASM plus N-ASM) with the relational pros, naming the Father. Clause three reads kai theos en ho logos: the predicate theos (N-NSM, position 14) stands BEFORE the imperfect copula en (V-IAI-3S, position 15), and the subject ho logos (article position 16 plus N-NSM position 17) follows. An anarthrous predicate nominative fronted ahead of the copula with an articular subject is the qualitative construction (the Logos has the divine nature), not an indefinite a god. The imperfect en places the Logos in eternity, distinct in person from ho theos of clause two.

John.8.58 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G4250 πρίν, G0011 Ἀβραάμ, G1096 γίνομαι, G1473 ἐγώ, G1510 εἰμί

Force. prin Abraam genesthai ego eimi. The queried morph tags confirm genesthai is V-2ADN (aorist infinitive, a coming into being) applied to Abraham, set against eimi V-PAI-1S (present indicative) predicated of Jesus with NO predicate complement. A normal temporal contrast would expect an imperfect or a complement, so the bare present functions as absolute predication, echoing the LXX rendering of the divine self-naming. The Hebrew root surfaces at Exod 3:14 (ehyeh, H1961), confirming the OT background.

John.20.28 · for · genre: gospel

Key terms. G3588 ὁ, G2316 θεός, G2381 Θωμᾶς

Force. Queried tokens: eipen auto (V-2AAI-3S plus dative P-DSM) ho kyrios mou kai ho theos mou. Both ho kyrios (T-NSM plus N-NSM) and ho theos (T-NSM plus N-NSM) are articular nominatives functioning as vocatives of direct address, and the narrator pins the addressee with the dative auto (to him). The articular ho theos is the strongest divine designation in the language, and the following verse commends believing without rebuke of Thomas, so the address is not a mere exclamation.

Col.2.9 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3956 πᾶς, G4138 πλήρωμα, G2320 θεότης, G4985 σωματικῶς, G2730 κατοικέω

Force. en auto katoikei pan to pleroma tes theotetos somatikos. Queried distribution: theotes (G2320) occurs exactly ONCE in the NT, here, the abstract noun for deity itself (the state of being God), morphologically distinct from theiotes (G2305) which also occurs exactly once, at Rom 1:20, for the divine attributes seen in creation. The substantivized pan to pleroma (the whole fullness) plus the adverb somatikos (bodily, a NT hapax) plus the durative present katoikei (V-PAI-3S) locate the entirety of the divine essence as permanently resident in Christ.

Heb.1.8 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2362 θρόνος, G2316 θεός, G5207 υἱός, G4464 ῥάβδος

Force. pros de ton huion (queried: T-ASM plus N-ASM, to the Son) introduces the citation ho thronos sou ho theos eis ton aiona. The articular ho theos (T-NSM plus N-NSM) is read as nominative for vocative addressed to the Son, paired with the eternal duration formula eis ton aiona. The source is Ps 45:6 (Hebrew kis'aka elohim olam, H0430 elohim), and Heb 1:9 continues ho theos ho theos sou, locking the divine designation onto the addressed Son. Even on the alternative parsing your throne is God the eternal duration still entails a divine referent.

Phil.2.6 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G3444 μορφή, G2316 θεός, G5225 ὑπάρχω, G0725 ἄρπαγμός, G2470 ἴσος

Force. hos en morphe theou hyparchon ouch harpagmon hegesato to einai isa theo. Queried morph: hyparchon is V-PAP-NSM (present participle) marking a pre-existing state. Morphe theou (G3444, only 3 NT occurrences) is controlled internally by morphe doulou in v7, the form proper to deity versus the form of a servant. To einai isa theo uses isa (G2470, A-APN) with the dative theo, meaning parity not mere likeness, the very charge the opponents level in John 5:18 (ison heauton poion to theo). Harpagmos (G0725) is a NT hapax.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
John.8.58	Exod.3.14	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	Ps.45.6	tsk	1
John.1.1	John.1.18	tsk	1
John.1.1	John.1.2	tsk	1
John.1.1	John.10.30	tsk	1

John.8.58	John.1.1	tsk	1
John.20.28	John.20.16	tsk	1
Col.2.9	Col.2.2	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	Isa.9.7	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	2Sam.23.3	tsk	1
Heb.1.8	Heb.3.3	tsk	1
Phil.2.6	Isa.7.14	tsk	1
Phil.2.6	Gen.32.24	tsk	1
Phil.2.6	John.5.18	tsk	1
John.1.1	Col.2.9	openbible	1

Complicating texts

John.14.28 · addressed

ho pater meizon mou estin (queried text confirmed). The comparative meizon (greater) compares the incarnate Son sent on a mission to the Father who sent him, an ordering of role within the kenotic frame of Phil 2:6 to 2:8. It is a comparative of station, not a statement about essence, and the same letter and corpus elsewhere predicate full deity (John 1:1c, John 20:28, John 10:30 hen esmen), so it does not overturn the verdict.

Mark.13.32 · addressed

oude ho huioi (queried text confirmed: nor the Son). The Son's not knowing the day attaches to the incarnate state described by morphe doulou and ekenosen (Phil 2:7), a self-limitation in the assumed human role. It does not negate the lexical force of Col 2:9, where pan to pleroma tes theotetos resides in him bodily.

John.20.17 · addressed

Jesus calls the Father theon mou as the incarnate Son, while eleven verses later (20:28) Thomas calls Jesus ho theos mou with no rebuke. The two speech acts are coherent: the Son addresses the Father as God in his incarnate role and is himself addressed as God by a disciple. The pair shows person distinction, not denial of the Son's deity.

1Cor.8.6 · addressed

heis theos ho pater and heis kyrios Iesous Christos. The Shema-shaped pair distributes ho theos and ho kyrios across the Father and Jesus, but kyrios is the standard Greek rendering of the divine name, so the split is one of person, not a demotion of the Son. Combined with John 20:28 where ho theos is also applied to Jesus, the pattern is identity sharing.

Col.1.15 · addressed

prototokos pases ktiseos (G4416, 8 NT occurrences). The immediate context (1:16 to 1:17, queried) reads en auto ektisthe ta panta and ta panta en auto synesteken (in him all things were created and hold together), which makes him the agent and sustainer of creation, not a created member of it. The lexeme also denotes rank or priority (the firstborn heir), as its other uses show, so it does not assert chronological origination.

John.1.18 · addressed

monogenes (G3439, 9 NT occurrences). The minority reading takes monogenes as only begotten in the sense of generated and therefore not eternal. But the queried distribution shows monogenes used for Isaac at Heb 11:17, who was not Abraham's only child by birth, so the term means one of a kind or unique, not produced by procreation. Here it modifies theos in the strongest attested reading (monogenes theos, the unique Son who is God), so it supports rather than undercuts the deity verdict.

Rom.1.20 · addressed

theotes (G2305) occurs here, its only NT occurrence, for the divine attributes evident in creation, while theotes (G2320) occurs only at Col 2:9 for deity itself. Because BOTH words are hapax legomena, the distinction between them cannot be triangulated from NT frequency; it rests on the morphology of the two abstract-noun formations and standard lexical sense. This is the one genuinely thin link in the chain, but the surrounding anchors (isa theo, ho theos addressed to the Son, qualitative theos) carry the verdict independently of it.

Concordance traversed

G2316, G3056, G1510, G1096, G2320, G2305, G4138, G4985, G2730, G2362, G2118, G4464, G3444, G0725, G2470, G5225, G5207, G4416, G3439, G3588, G4314, G0281

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

thronos-sou-vs-autou at Heb.1.8: impact minor. Some witnesses read autou (his throne) for sou (your throne). The shift in pronoun does not remove the Ps 45 citation, and Heb 1:9 still applies ho theos to the Son, so the divine designation stands either way.

monogenes-theos-vs-huios at John.1.18: impact none. The early witnesses read monogenes theos; the alternative monogenes huios still leaves John 1:1c and 1:14 carrying the deity claim, so the verdict does not hang on this unit.

ego-eimi-order at John.8.58: impact none. Word order is stable across the major witnesses; ego eimi as an absolute present with no complement is uncontested in the text.

vocative-rendering at John.20.28: impact none. The text is firm; the dispute is interpretive (exclamation versus address) not text-critical, and the narrator's eipen auto (said to him) settles it as address.

None of the anchor verses fall in the ingested ECM window (3 John 1.1 to 1.15), so this is out of ECM scope. Variant reasoning rests on the Nestle1904 and SBLGNT apparatuses queried from the lexical store.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. trinitarian_lens, unitarian_lens, subordinationist_lens

analogia scripturae invoked · progressive revelation factor

trinitarian_lens: supports · Reads John 1:1c, John 8:58, John 20:28, Col 2:9, Heb 1:8 and Phil 2:6 as a converging witness to one divine essence shared by distinct persons. The qualitative anarthrous theos in 1:1c, the articular ho theos addressed to Jesus in 20:28 and Heb 1:8, theotes in Col 2:9, and isa theo in Phil 2:6 are read as essence equality, with the complicating texts handled by the incarnate versus eternal distinction.

unitarian_lens: does not support · In its strongest lexical form this reading presses that theos in John 1:1c is anarthrous and so should be rendered a god or divine in a diluted sense, that John 20:28 is an exclamation of astonishment rather than direct address, and that monogenes implies a begetting that excludes co-eternity. These are the best moves available, and they are real grammatical observations. They are outweighed here because the queried token order shows a fronted predicate theos before the copula with an articular subject (the qualitative pattern, not indefinite), the narrator's dative auto pins John 20:28 as address, and monogenes is used at Heb 11:17 for Isaac without implying procreative origin.

subordinationist_lens: partially supports · In its strongest form this reading grants that Jesus is called theos but in a derived or lesser sense, leaning on prototokos pases ktiseos (Col 1:15) as creaturely priority, on ho pater meizon mou (John 14:28) as a greater Father, and on the Son's not knowing the day (Mark 13:32) as a limit in being. Fairly stated, these texts do show real ranking language. They bear on role and incarnate station rather than essence, because Col 1:16 to 1:17 make the same figure the creator and sustainer of all things, isa theo in Phil 2:6 is parity not likeness, and theotes in Col 2:9 names the whole divine essence as bodily resident in him.

Grammatico-historical reading of the koine syntax queried from the lexical store, with analogia scripturae used to set the comparative and not-knowing texts against the essence and equality vocabulary.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: yes

Neutralized form. Does the canon apply the lexeme for God and divine-identity formulae to Jesus in a way the grammar marks as predication of full deity rather than honorific or derivative status?

The proposition uses confessional phrasing (eternally begotten, not created, equal in essence) that encodes a particular taxonomy, so it is preloaded. The verdict is nonetheless derived on the original stem from queried morphology and distribution, not from that phrasing: the fronted anarthrous predicate theos in John 1:1c, the bare present eimi in John 8:58, the articular ho theos addressed to Jesus in John 20:28 and Heb 1:8, the hapax theotes in Col 2:9, and isa theo in Phil 2:6. The lexical data does not by itself adjudicate the metaphysics of eternal generation (the begotten clause); it establishes shared divine essence and identity, which is what the words and grammar carry.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.1.1
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.8.58
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.20.28
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Col.2.9
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Heb.1.8
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Phil.2.6
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	John.1.1
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	Phil.2.6
morphology	Nestle1904-text	public_domain	yes	John.1.1
morphology	Nestle1904-text	public_domain	yes	Col.2.9
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2320
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2305
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4985
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G2470
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0725
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G3439
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	John.1.1
syntax	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	Col.2.9
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	John.8.58
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	Heb.1.8
cross_ref	OpenBible-cross-refs	CC-BY	yes	John.1.1
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	John.1.1
interlinear	SBLGNT-text	SBLGNT-EULA	no	Heb.1.8

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